I Found Peace In Your Violence

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/51214852.

Rating:
General Audiences

Archive Warning:
Creator Chose Not To Use Archive Warnings, No Archive Warnings Apply

Category:
F/F, F/M

Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

Relationship:
Adora & Bow & Catra & Glimmer (She-Ra), Bow/Glimmer (She-Ra), Adora/Catra (She-Ra)

Character:
Glimmer (She-Ra), Bow (She-Ra), Adora (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra), Horde Prime (mentioned), Castaspella (Mentioned)

Additional Tags:
Alternate Universe - Modern Setting, Apocalypse, glimmer pov, Mentioned Horde Prime (She-Ra), Clone Apocalypse, Glimmer's a badass, a badass who gets stabbed but still, Best Friend Squad (She-Ra), Some Humor, Bow's just trying to be friendly, First Meetings, First Aid, Mentioned Castaspella (She-Ra)

Language:
English

Series:
Part 1 of Apocalypse AU

Stats:
Published: 2023-10-30 Words: 3,250 Chapters: 1/1

I Found Peace In Your Violence

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/51214852.

Rating:
General Audiences

Archive Warning:
Creator Chose Not To Use Archive Warnings, No Archive Warnings Apply

Category:
F/F, F/M

Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

Relationship:
Adora & Bow & Catra & Glimmer (She-Ra), Bow/Glimmer (She-Ra), Adora/Catra (She-Ra)

Character:
Glimmer (She-Ra), Bow (She-Ra), Adora (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra), Horde Prime (mentioned), Castaspella (Mentioned)

Additional Tags:
Alternate Universe - Modern Setting, Apocalypse, glimmer pov, Mentioned Horde Prime (She-Ra), Clone Apocalypse, Glimmer's a badass, a badass who gets stabbed but still, Best Friend Squad (She-Ra), Some Humor, Bow's just trying to be friendly, First Meetings, First Aid, Mentioned Castaspella (She-Ra)

Language:
English

Series:
Part 1 of Apocalypse AU

Stats:

Published: 2023-10-30 Words: 3,250 Chapters: 1/1

I Found Peace In Your Violence

by Randomdork

Summary

"Who are you people? Where am I?" She asks with narrowed eyes.

"My name is Bow, and these are my best friends, Adora and Catra" he says, pointing to the other people. "And as for where you are- uh- I guess this is just where we're camping out for the night"

"What happened?" Glimmer groans, pain hitting her a thousand times harder as she clutches at her side.

"You were fighting a clone- and you were doing really well!" He tells her before his nervous smile fades to a frown "Well, um, until the clone… It uh… The thing is the clone it… it sort of um-"

"You got stabbed" one of the women, Catra she thinks, states in a much more blunt manner.

"Catra!"

"What? I'm just telling her what happened"

Glimmer gets injured in a fight and saved by two of the friendliest, most persistent people ever. Oh, and Catra.

Aka the apocalypse fic nobody asked for.

Notes

See the end of the work for notes

Glimmer read ‘The Fault In Our Stars’ when she was 13, it wasn’t really her thing, but the whole comparison between falling in love and falling asleep always stood out to her. That idea of something happening slowly, then all at once.

Years later, she realizes that being in the middle of an apocalypse isn’t all that different.

“Up and coming scientist, H. Prime, is swearing that he has a plan to “reform” the world, while he hasn’t disclosed exactly how he plans to do this, he has discussed…”

That’s how it started, with a couple of news reports. Prime had given her a weird feeling, so she’d always just change the channel. But then he created clones. He made a couple of them, a bit weird, but Glimmer had assumed it was just a stupid news headline that would come and go within the week. Except they didn’t. A couple turned to five, and then five turned to ten and then there was an army of clones infecting people with chips. Society went from gradually declining to falling off a fucking cliff. Glimmer went from watching shit about the clones on the tv to having to fight them off in her own home. She left not long after that, she can’t remember how long it’s been.

All she knows is that nowhere’s felt safe since.

Travelling alone isn’t exactly great, nothing about this situation is, but in all of the chaos she’s found some sort of morbid routine. She’s figured out what routes help her avoid the clones, and even

when she does run into them, her fighting skills have usually been good enough to get her away safely.

Until today that is.

It was an ambush- it's always a fucking ambush- but she's been holding her own so far. Hit after hit, she's taking every clone that comes at her with her bo staff. Glimmer has a feeling that this fight will be done in the next five minutes or so if she's lucky, almost all of them have been knocked out, and the one that's left looks determined but still close to collapse. She rams her bo staff into the head of, who she thinks is, the last clone, watching it fall to the ground. Glimmer doesn't even get to feel relief before there's a shock of cold, searing pain devouring her body. She looks down and sees red.

Since when can these clones stab people?

Everything goes numb as Glimmer's vision starts swimming. She stumbles to the ground, struggling to stay awake as one of the clones starts towering over her. Her eyelids feel so heavy and everything is blurry.

The last thing she sees before she passes out is an arrow colliding with a clone.

xxx

The first thought Glimmer has when she wakes up is that she can't remember the last time she felt so comfortable. The second thought she has is that she has no idea where the fuck she is.

She's in some sort of tent, she thinks. There's two women, one blonde and one who looks weirdly similar to a cat, sitting in the corner whispering as they each steal glances at her, and some guy in a crop top staring down at her, he's actually kind of cu-

Nope. Not the time, Glimmer.

As soon as the situation fully registers in her head, she shoots up, ignoring the burning pain that flares in her side as she does so.

"Woah, hey, take it easy" the guy tells her gently with, what she assumes is supposed to be, a reassuring smile "Everything's okay"

"Who are you people? Where am I?" She asks with narrowed eyes.

"My name is Bow, and these are my best friends, Adora and Catra" he says, pointing to the other people "And as for where you are- uh- I guess this is just where we're camping out for the night"

“What happened?” Glimmer groans, pain hitting her a thousand times harder as she clutches at her side.

“You were fighting a clone- and you were doing really well!” He tells her before his nervous smile fades to a frown “Well, um, until the clone… It uh… The thing is the clone it… it sort of um-”

“You got stabbed” one of the women, Catra she thinks, states in a much more blunt manner.

“Catra!”

“What? I’m just telling her what happened”

“Well, that explains the pain” Glimmer grimaces.

“I know a lot of first aid, I’ve tried to patch you up as best I can” Bow says to her, before he begins blushing furiously “I uh- I kind of had to lift your shirt so I could take a look at the wound, but I didn’t see anything inappropriate! I swear!”

“See, you saying that makes me think you *definitely* did”

“I didn’t!” He insists frantically, pointing at the other two “I have witnesses!”

“Unless all three of you-”

“NO”

“Oh my gods, relax, I’m just messing with you” she can’t help but laugh a little “Thanks for doing that, I appreciate it”

“O-oh, you’re welcome” he deflates in an instant, and Glimmer has to hold back another set of giggles. He smiles at her “Well, like I said, I did the best I could, but you should still get a lot of rest for the next week or so”

“I’m not exactly in a position to do that”

“I know, but you should still try when you have the chance” he flashes a small smile, before clearing her throat “I uh- I couldn’t help but notice that you were by yourself in that fight”

“Yeah” she moves around, trying to find a comfortable position “And?”

“Well, I um- I just- Have you been travelling by yourself? Did you get separated from anyone? Or-”

“I’m by myself” she tells him, mostly so he’ll stop rambling out questions.

“Oh- Oh! Well, if you want, you’re welcome to travel with us” Bow says, smiling in an almost nervous way, she can see Adora nodding from behind him. Catra just looks passive “We’re going into the Whispering Woods, to my dads’ library, we figure it’ll be safe there”

“Thanks, but I’m good” Glimmer dismisses with ease, not missing how Bow’s face falls “I’m headed to Mystacor, opposite direction”

“Are you sure you don’t want to come with us?” He tries again “It’ll be safer”

“I don’t want to make this journey any longer than it needs to be, the quicker I get to Mystacor the better”

“I know, and I get that, but travelling by yourself while you’re injured doesn’t seem like a good idea. That stab wound is going to slow you down, whether you like it or not. If you come to my dads’ library, you can rest as much as you need, and then leave for Mystacor when you’re ready”

When he puts it like that, Glimmer has to admit that it doesn’t sound like a plan. Plus, if she’s being honest, the incessant stinging sensation in her side is a bitch. Getting a chance to rest properly doesn’t sound too bad…

But then images of her aunt, scared and defending off clones *alone* flood mind, and Glimmer can't stop the guilt that comes with it. Maybe rest would be nice, but her aunt needs her, that's the only thing that matters.

"Stab wound feels like an exaggeration" she attempts to dismiss, although the spike of pain that causes her to clutch her side and gasp as she shifts probably undermines her point.

"Yeah, no, not really" One of the women speaks up "Take it from the people who watched you get stabbed"

"It uh- It *did* seem pretty bad" the other woman- Adora?- agrees.

She grimaces, why did she have to be saved by the most persistent people alive? "I'll be fine"

"And if the clones attack you again? And you get stabbed, again?" Catra challenges "You realize you're lucky we found you, right? You might not be so lucky next time"

"Catra has a point" Bow says "Four against however many clones is still better than one"

“Okay, okay, fine. You have a point” agitation rises in Glimmer’s veins as her resolve begins to slip away “Look, it’s late, I’m still in a lot of pain and I’m tired. Can I sleep on it and get back to you in the morning?”

“Uh- yeah, sure!” Bow says, looking a little pleased “Do you have a sleeping bag or anything? Because if not-”

She gestures to the bag attached to the side of her backpack in the corner “I keep my tent in there, I can set it up”

Adora picks it up for her “Do you want any help with that?”

She hesitates “You don’t have to-”

“I want to” she smiles kindly at her “Come on, let’s go”

Bow helps her get up, she thanks him before following Adora, her movements slower than she’d like them to be.

Stupid stab wounds.

xxx

“I don’t know if this’ll actually help or not, but I have some painkillers if you ever want them”

Glimmer looks at her for a second before focusing her attention on the tent again “That would be great, thanks”

“Cool, they’re in my tent, I’ll bring them over before you go to sleep” Adora smiles at her.

“You know, you’re the first person I’ve run into who *actually* keeps painkillers for injuries. That’s a smart move”

Glimmer would do that if she knew where the fuck to get painkillers from now. She supposes there must be travellers selling them for money or some other sort of currency. She might have to look into that in the future.

“That and they’re great for period cramps too” she says. Glimmer grimaces and nods, impressed. Her cramps have definitely caused more pain than the clones on one occasion.

“So you clearly like to think ahead”

“Uh- yeah, I guess I do” Adora replies “I’m kind of in charge of strategy. Planning routes, figuring out what fighting moves to use against the clones, stuff like that”

“I can see why they put you in charge, you clearly know what you’re doing”

“Thanks” The blonde woman smiles at her “You know, I like to train whenever I can. Maybe, if you stayed, you could train with me and Catra? It’ll help with the recovery”

She bites her lip, adjusting the piece of wood that is already very clearly staked in the ground “Yeah, if I stayed, that would be nice”

“Awesome!” She cheers “Well, I better get some sleep, I’m absolutely exhausted, but let me know when you want those painkillers, okay?”

“Will do” Glimmer replies “Night, Adora”

“Goodnight!” Adora pauses “For what it’s worth, I think it would be cool if you stayed. It’d be nice to have someone new around”

Glimmer doesn’t respond to that, simply hesitates as she watches Adora walk away and go back into her tent- but wait, isn’t that Catra’s tent? She could’ve sworn she saw Catra go in there earlier. They must be sharing. But why are they sharing? Surely Adora has her ow-

Oh.

Oh.

Yeah, that makes a lot of sense. She's a little surprised she didn't see that sooner.

It doesn't take long for Glimmer's thoughts to drift back to what Adora said, and it makes her frown. Travelling with Bow, Adora and Catra is a more appealing thought than she'd like it to be. These people… They seem nice. And it's been such a long time since Glimmer's been around- well, anyone, really.

But isn't that the whole reason she's going to Mystacor? So she can be with her aunt? Aunt Casta is the only family she has left, surely she could come first over a few people she barely knows? Besides, Glimmer's lost enough people in her life at this point to know it's better not to get attached to people. Really, she should leave and go to Mystacor.

But if that's the case, why does a part of her *still* not want to?

"Glimmer!" She hears, she turns to see Bow coming towards her "Hey"

"Hi" she replies "What's up? Do you need something?"

“I just wanted to come and say goodnight” he smiles a bit sheepishly “And maybe make my case about why you should come with us?”

If this were anyone else, Glimmer would be irritated. But Bow is so cute, she can’t help but find it kind of endearing (ironically, her finding it endearing is actually the thing that irritates her more than anything else)

“Alright, fine, I’ll hear you out” she says gesturing to her tent “But let’s sit in there, it’s freezing”

It’s a bit of a tight fit, but they both just about manage to get into her tent. Bow wastes no time “Look, obviously I can’t tell you what to do, or make any decision for you. But I really think it would be a good idea if you came to my dads’ library with us”

“Why?” Glimmer can’t help but ask “You don’t even know me”

“I don’t need to know you. Nobody should have to travel alone. Especially when they’re injured. You need to rest”

“I’ve been injured by myself before and handled it just fine” she counters, trying to see how far she can push her limits with her stubbornness.

But Bow doesn't seem undeterred, if anything, he might actually look *more* determined "I get that, but just because you *can* deal with it by yourself, that doesn't mean you should *have* to, you know?"

Glimmer blinks, unsure what to do with that. She's not sure she's ever met someone outside of her family who's been so… Considerate of her. Nice to her.

Ugh, he's sweet. Too sweet. This should be sickly… But she still finds it kind of cute. For fuck's sake, Glimmer wishes he wasn't so attractive, it totally undercuts how annoying he should be "Look, I appreciate the concern but I don't need any pity-"

"It's not pity!" Bow exclaims, cutting her off "It's really not, I promise! It's just- I don't know, it's always nice to make a new friend. Now more than ever. The chance doesn't exactly come up all that often"

"Yeah, well, I've gone my whole life without friends and I've been fine"

He stares at her, and it makes Glimmer want the tent to collapse on her and swallow her whole "Really?"

Her defenses prickle up as she crosses her arms "Stop looking at me like that. Lots of people prefer being alone, it's not that weird"

“What? No! No, sorry, I didn’t mean- I don’t- I *definitely* don’t think you’re weird” Bow clarified “I was just- surprised, I guess? I would’ve thought you’d have tons of friends in school”

“Yeah, no, that was *not* the case” A laugh escapes before she can think about it “Honestly, it’s not a big deal. Other kids didn’t like me, and I didn’t like them, it was a mutual thing”

“I just… It’s hard to imagine people not liking you” Bow tells her, voice sincere.

Glimmer isn’t blushing. She is *not* blushing.

(Shut up)

“You’ve only known me for like, a few hours, and I was passed out for a lot of that” she deflects with ease “Trust me, if I stayed you would stop liking me pretty quickly”

“I highly doubt that” he frowns.

“You’d be surprised at how easy it is”

And then he grins, much to Glimmer's confusion "Oh yeah? Wanna bet on that?"

She raises an eyebrow at him "What?"

"Travel with us for a week. If, by the end of the week, me and the others don't like you, then fine, you can go on by yourself and we'll never see each other again"

"And if you all still like me then I go with you to your dads library?" Glimmer finishes for him.

"Exactly" his grin remains fixed in place "So? What do you say?"

She smiles at him "I'll think about it"

"I'll take it" he goes to leave the tent, facing a small struggle as he practically shimmies out "I'll let you get some sleep, goodnight, Glimmer"

"Night" she says and then asks before she can stop herself "Hey, Bow?"

His head appears through the entrance flap "Yeah?"

Glimmer fiddles with her fingers “Why is this so important to you? Me staying”

Bow simply smiles at her “Before I met Adora and Catra, I didn’t have any friends either. And I spent most of my childhood that way. It wasn’t awful or anything but- I don’t know, I guess when I see people who are by themselves like I was- I just like being the friend that I wish I’d had growing up”

Somehow, his answer doesn’t shock her in the slightest, although she’s a bit surprised anyone could dislike the literal human embodiment of kindness “That’s… Really sweet, actually”

“I’m glad you think so” he pauses “Okay, I’ll actually let you get some sleep now. Goodnight, Glimmer”

“Goodnight, Bow” she gives him a little wave.

As she settles into sleep, she can’t help but muse over how strange the day has been. Ever since Prime and weird clones practically took over Etheria, Glimmer has assumed that life was done giving her surprises. Afterall, what surprise could beat a fucking apocalypse?

Bow, Adora and Catra apparently. And Glimmer has a feeling that if she stays a lot of surprises will be in store for her.

xxx

Glimmer wakes up groggy and in pain, but she knows what she wants to do.

She quickly gets ready and heads over to Bow, Catra and Adora as they sit, huddled together and eating breakfast “Morning”

“Glimmer!” Bow smiles, instantly making room for her, she takes a seat next to him.

“We saved some breakfast for you” Catra says, passing her a plate.

“Oh- um- thanks”

There's an instant twisting sensation in her stomach that reminds Glimmer of the fact that she hasn’t eaten anything in… Oh shit, when was the last time she ate something? Doesn’t matter, at least she has food now. She hopes her starvation isn’t too obvious as she begins eating, each bite is like heaven in her mouth.

“How did you sleep?” Bow asks her.

“Pretty good, all things considered” she points to her side “This is still a bitch though”

He grimaces, expression becoming more apologetic “Yeah uh- it’s gonna be like that for a while, unfortunately”

“Mmm” she hums “At least I know that the clones can do that, I’ll know how to block it next time”

“Hopefully that ‘next time’ won’t be happening any time soon” Adora speaks up “If the route I planned is correct, we shouldn’t be in any danger of running into any clones for the next day or two. Plus there are plenty of spots for us to take breaks so you can get rest”

“Hang on, Adora, Glimmer may not be coming with us” Bow says before looking at her, smile wide “Unless you’ve thought anymore about the bet I proposed?”

She bites her lip, holding back a grin of her own “I have”

“And?” He holds his hand out and the little sparkle in his eyes gives her a feeling that he already knows the answer.

Glimmer glances at Adora and Catra, not surprised to see them wearing expectant expressions. She looks back at Bow with a

smirk and shakes his hand, what harm could a week possibly do? “You’re on”

End Notes

Yeah so I think it's pretty obvious that I basically know nothing about writing apocalypse fiction but I had an idea and here we are. I'm going to try and turn this into a series, so hopefully the future instalments will be better than this one lol

Also I know Catra wasn't in this one much, but she has a much bigger role in the next part.

Until next time!

Sho :))

Please drop by the archive and comment to let the author know if you enjoyed their work!